Topic 14 — Final Phase of Freedom Struggle

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Congress (कांग्रेस) Socialist Party | Subhash Chandra Bose | Forward Bloc (फॉरवर्ड ब्लॉक) | Quit India (भारत छोड़ो) Movement | Azad Hind (आज़ाद हिंद) Fauj (फौज) | Azad Hind Government (सरकार) | Second World War and India | Political Deadlock | Desai (आमिल)–Liaquat Pact | Final Phase (1945–47) | Independence Chronology | INA (आज़ाद हिंद फौज) Trials | Cabinet Mission (कैबिनेट मिशन) | Cripps (क्रिप्स) Mission | Wavell Plan (वेवेल योजना) | Simla Conference | Plan Balkan / Dickie Bird | Mountbatten Plan (माउंटबेटन योजना) | Indian Independence Act (अधिनियम) 1947 | RIN Mutiny | Direct Action Day

Sources baked in: Spectrum, Bipan Chandra, NCERT Themes III, Ghatnachakra Purvalokan (1937–QI / Pakistan / Cripps; Bose–INA; Cabinet–Partition), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — mission chronology, Bose/INA, Quit India women, Cabinet Mission A/R, Independence Act **Last verified:** September 2026 gap audit — CCR confirmed on Cripps, Quit India, INA, Wavell/Simla, Cabinet Mission, RIN, Mountbatten; CSP + Desai–Liaquat + Plan Balkan cards filled; identity-line glue fixed; Extra Drill present (no invented mega banks) **Current Affairs:** N/A (historical)

14.1 Independence Chronology

Year	Event
1937	Provincial elections; Congress ministries **formed** in most provinces
1939	Congress ministries **resign** (WWII, no consultation)
Mar 1940	Ramgarh Congress; League Lahore / Pakistan resolution
Aug 1940	August Offer (Linlithgow)
Oct 1940	Individual Satyagraha (Vinoba first; Nehru later)
Mar 1942	**Cripps Mission**
8 Aug 1942	**Quit India** (Bombay)
21 Oct 1943	**Azad Hind Government**, Singapore
Jun–Jul 1945	**Wavell Plan + Simla Conference**
Nov 1945–46	**INA Trials**, Red Fort
Jan 1946	UK Parliamentary Delegation
Feb 1946	**RIN Revolt**; Cabinet Mission announced
Mar–May 1946	Cabinet Mission in India; plan **16 May 1946**

Year	Event
16 Aug 1946	Direct Action Day
2 Sep 1946	Interim Government (Congress); League joins **26 Oct**
20 Feb 1947	Attlee: transfer by June 1948
3 Jun 1947	**Mountbatten Plan**
18 Jul 1947	**Indian Independence Act**
15 Aug 1947	Independence / Partition

> **Logic:** Wavell/Simla (**1945**) sits after Cripps (**1942**) and before Cabinet Mission (**1946**). Full mission cards below.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q41

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims Chronology)**: Cripps Mission (March 1942) → Wavell Plan (June 1945) → Simla Conference (June–July 1945) → Cabinet Mission (March–May 1946).

14.2 Congress Ministries (1937–39)

Election: provincial elections under the **Government of India Act, 1935**, held in **early 1937 Result:** Congress won a majority of seats in **six provinces outright** (Madras, Bombay, UP, Bihar, Orissa, CP) and was the largest party in others

Cause

- The **Government of India Act, 1935** introduced provincial autonomy and made elected ministries possible. Congress first hesitated over office-acceptance, since ministries would work **inside** a scheme it had itself rejected as inadequate.
- After the Viceroy (वायसराय) assured that provincial governors would not routinely override ministries, Congress agreed to **accept office**.

Course

- **Congress ministries were formed in eight provinces**: Madras, Bombay, UP, Bihar, Orissa, CP, Assam and NWFP, either alone or in coalition (गठबंधन), through **1937**.
- Ministries pushed **civil-liberties measures** — released political prisoners, relaxed press curbs — and some **social legislation**, such as debt-relief and tenancy protection in a few provinces.
- The **Muslim League**, which had done poorly in Muslim-majority seats, felt shut out where Congress refused coalition offers; this experience hardened League grievances that later fed the Pakistan demand.
- On **3 September 1939**, Britain declared India at war without consulting elected Indian opinion. The **Congress Working Committee** demanded a clear statement of British war aims for India and a real

move toward self-government; the offer was refused.
- Congress ministries in all eight provinces **resigned in October–November 1939** in protest.

Result

- Ministries lasted about **28 months**. UP Premier tag: **Govind Ballabh Pant**; Finance **Rafi Ahmed Kidwai**.
- League grievance reports in order: **Pirpur Report (1938)** → **Sharif Report (Mar 1939)** → **Fazlul Haq / Muslim Sufferings report (Dec 1939)**.
- Jinnah asked Muslims to observe **22 December 1939** as **Day of Deliverance** after Congress resignations.
- The two-year experience of running provincial government gave Congress administrative practice and exposed Congress–League friction well before the 1940s.

> **Logic:** Ministries **formed 1937** after the provincial elections; they **resigned 1939** over the war. Eight provinces, not all eleven British Indian provinces.

14.3 Congress Socialist Party

Year: 1934 (Bombay meeting / formal organisation through that year — not a January-only founding date trap) **Stream:** socialist group **inside** Congress **Key names:** Jayaprakash Narayan, Acharya Narendra Dev, Ram Manohar Lohia, Minoo Masani, Yusuf Meherally (circle varies by book)

Cause

- Younger Congressmen wanted a sharper **anti-imperial and socialist** programme after the Civil Disobedience (सविनय अवज्ञा) years, without leaving the Congress mass organisation for the CPI (सीपीआई) or a separate party.

Course

- The **Congress Socialist Party** worked as a left wing **inside Congress**, pressing land reform, workers' rights and uncompromising struggle while accepting the broader national movement.
- **Jawaharlal Nehru (जवाहरलाल नेहरू) sympathised** with many CSP ideas but **never formally joined** the party — a classic UPPCS trap.
- CSP is **not** Bose's **Forward Bloc (1939)** and **not** the Communist Party of India.

Result

- CSP kept a socialist current alive inside Congress through the late 1930s and into the wartime years; several CSP leaders later became major post-1947 opposition and socialist figures.
- Do **not** merge CSP with Forward Bloc, CPI, or Swaraj (स्वराज) Party (**1923**).

> **Logic:** CSP ≠ Forward Bloc. CSP ≠ CPI. Nehru never formally joined.

14.4 Subhas Chandra Bose (सुभाष चंद्र बोस)

- Born **23 January 1897** at **Cuttack** (Odisha); Scottish Church College graduate; selected for **ICS (1920)** then quit. Title **Netaji** (नेताजी) is keyed to the **Germany** phase.
- **Rabindranath Tagore** called him **Desh Nayak**; Gandhi called him the **Patriot of Patriots**.
- Political guru (गुरु) often keyed = **C.R. Das**.
- He was Congress President at **Haripura 1938** and **Tripuri 1939**.
- At **Tripuri** he defeated Gandhi's candidate **Pattabhi Sitaramayya**; Working-Committee disputes forced his resignation, and **Rajendra Prasad** took the presidency (प्रेसीडेंसी).
- He founded **Forward Bloc in 1939**. It is left-nationalist, not CSP. **Sheel Bhadra Yajee** joined him in founding the All India Forward Bloc and later worked with the INA stream.
- He treated a Britain–Germany war as a **godsend** chance to strike for freedom.
- He escaped Calcutta in **January 1941** as "Ziauddin" and reached **Germany**, where he set up the **Free India Centre** and raised the **Free Indian Legion** from Indian POWs (North Africa / Rommel theatre tag).
- He then went by submarine to South-East Asia in **1943**.
- He took over INA from the **Rash Behari Bose / Mohan Singh** stream.
- He proclaimed **Azad Hind Government** on **21 October 1943** at **Singapore**.
- His slogans include **"Give me blood and I will give you freedom"**, **Delhi Chalo**, and **Jai Hind**.
- His books are *The Indian Struggle* and *An Indian Pilgrim*.
- Bose **did** preside over Congress, unlike Tilak (तिलक).

> **Logic:** Bose = Haripura/Tripuri + Forward Bloc 1939 + INA + Azad Hind Govt 1943.

14.5 Forward Bloc

Year: 1939 Founder: Subhas Chandra Bose (सुभाष चंद्र बोस)

- After Tripuri, Bose left the Congress high command but stayed in the nationalist stream.
- Forward Bloc is **not** the Congress Socialist Party of 1934 and **not** the CPI.
- Its aim was uncompromising struggle for independence.
- Wartime Bose politics then ran through the INA, not through a mass Indian party machine.

> **Logic:** Forward Bloc **1939 Bose**. CSP **1934** inside Congress.

14.6 Second World War and India

- Britain declared India at war in **September 1939** without consulting Congress.
- **Congress ministries resigned** in late 1939.
- League observed **Deliverance Day**.

- **Iqbal** floated a consolidated north-west Muslim homeland at the League's **Allahabad (इलाहाबाद) session (पंगु सत्र) (1930)**. Cambridge student **Chaudhary Rahmat Ali** coined **Pakstan/Pakistan** in the **1933** pamphlet ***Now or Never***.
- The League's **Lahore session (22–24 March 1940)**, President **Jinnah**, passed the Pakistan resolution (draft often keyed to **Sikandar Hayat Khan**; moved by **Fazlul Haq**). **23 March 1943** was later marked **Pakistan Day**.
- **Sarojini Naidu** had earlier called Jinnah **Ambassador of Hindu–Muslim Unity**. Iqbal's line in Nehru's telling: Nehru a patriot, Jinnah a politician.
- **Ramgarh Congress** met in **March 1940**. **Azad** was President.
- The **August Offer** came on **8 August 1940** under **Linlithgow**.
- It offered to expand the Executive Council, a war advisory body, and dominion after the war.
- It also gave **minorities a veto** on a future constitution.
- Congress rejected it. The League rejected it because Pakistan was not clear.
- **Individual Satyagraha** began in **October 1940**.
- **Vinoba Bhave** was first. **Nehru** (नेहरू) was among those jailed.
- It was symbolic, not mass Civil Disobedience.
- Order: ministries resign (**1939**), then Ramgarh (**March 1940**), then August Offer (**August 1940**), then Cripps (**March 1942**).

> **Logic:** August Offer **1940** ≠ Cripps **1942**. Ministries resign **1939**.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q133):** Chronology ladder: Resignation of Congress Ministries (Oct 1939) → Ramgarh Congress Session (March 1940) → Linlithgow August Offer (Aug 1940) → Cripps Mission arrival (March 1942).

14.7 Cripps Mission (March 1942)

Who: Sir **Stafford Cripps** (Labour, War Cabinet) **When: March 1942** (after Japan's advance)

Cause

- Japan's rapid advance through South-East Asia in early 1942 threatened India directly, and Britain's wartime allies, especially the US, pressed London to win genuine Indian support for the war effort.

Course

- Sir **Stafford Cripps** brought an offer in **March 1942**: **Dominion Status (डोमिनियन) after the war**, a **Constituent Assembly** (संविधान सभा), and the right of any province to **opt out** of the Union. Immediate control of defence stayed with the British for the duration of the war.
- Gandhi dismissed the offer as **"a post-dated cheque on a crashing bank."**
- **Jawaharlal Nehru** (जवाहरलाल नेहरू) and **Maulana Azad** were Congress's official negotiators with Cripps.

Result

- **Congress rejected** it: there was no immediate national government, and the opt-out clause threatened Indian unity.
- The **League rejected** it too, since there was no express commitment to Pakistan.
- The failure of Cripps became the direct climate for **Quit India** later that year.

> **Logic:** Cripps = **1942**, not 1946. 1946 = Cabinet Mission.

14.8 Quit India Movement (8 August 1942)

Place: Bombay (Gowalia Tank / August Kranti Maidan (मैदान)) **Slogan: Do or Die Resolution:** Wardha in July, then Bombay AICC on **8 August 1942**

Cause

- The failure of the Cripps Mission convinced Gandhi and Congress that Britain would offer no genuine transfer of power short of a final push, and Congress resolved to demand immediate British withdrawal.

Course

- The Congress Working Committee passed the "Quit India" resolution at Wardha in July, adopted (अंगीकृत) by the AICC at Bombay on **8 August 1942**, with Gandhi's call of **"Do or Die."**
- **Yusuf Meher Ali** is keyed with coining the slogan **Quit India**. Nehru moved the Bombay AICC resolution; Patel supported; Azad was Congress President (Ramgarh 1940 continuity).
- Arrests under **Operation Zero Hour (शून्य काल)** (**9 August**): Gandhi and Sarojini Naidu to **Aga Khan Palace**; many Working Committee members to **Ahmednagar Fort**; Rajendra Prasad (not in Bombay) to **Bankipur (Patna (पटना))** jail.
- American journalist **Louis Fischer** (Gandhi's biographer) was with Gandhi in this season. **Linlithgow** called the rising the most serious since **1857**, citing peasant fury in eastern UP–Bihar.
- All top leaders were arrested on **8–9 August**, so the movement ran **leaderless and underground**.
- **Aruna Asaf Ali** hoisted the flag at Gowalia Tank; **Usha Mehta** ran **Congress Radio** from Bombay; **Matangini Hazra**, 73, was shot at Tamluk while carrying the flag; **Kanaklata Barua** fell at Gohpur in Assam.
- Parallel governments rose at **Ballia** under **Chittu Pandey** in UP, at **Tamluk** in Midnapore, and as the **Satara Prati Sarkar** under **Nana Patil**; Talcher is another stock name.
- **Shanti Ghosh** was **not** a Quit India woman — she belongs to the **1931** Bengal revolutionary (क्रांतिकारी) shooting with Suniti Chaudhuri, not 1942.

Result

- Brutal repression crushed the movement's open, organised phase within months, and it did not immediately throw the British out.
- It did convince British opinion that ruling India by force indefinitely was unsustainable, making a negotiated post-war exit unavoidable.

> **Logic:** QI women = Aruna, Matangini, Kanaklata. **Shanti Ghosh ≠ QI**.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q48)**: Shanti Ghosh was NOT associated with Quit India 1942; she and Suniti Chaudhary shot dead Magistrate Stevens in Comilla in December 1931. Matangini Hazra, Aruna Asaf Ali, and Kanaklata Barua were prominent Quit India martyrs/leaders.

14.9 Azad Hind Fauj and Azad Hind Government

Cause

- Indian prisoners of war captured by Japan in South-East Asia, together with émigré nationalists such as **Rash Behari Bose**, wanted an armed Indian force to fight alongside Japan and free India by force rather than by negotiation with Britain.

Course

- Idea-circle for the first INA is often keyed to **Giani Pritam Singh** and Japanese Major **Iwaichi Fujiwara**; **Capt. Mohan Singh** became the first operational commander (**15 July 1942** formation tag; first division **Sept 1942**). Leadership distrust with **Rash Behari Bose** later dissolved that first INA.
- On **4 July 1943** Rash Behari Bose handed command to **Subhas Chandra Bose**, who rebuilt the force at **Singapore** (then British Malaya).
- The **Provisional Government of Free India (Azad Hind)** was proclaimed on **21 October 1943** at Singapore (recognised by about **nine** Axis/friendly states in GC memory). Andaman (अंडमान) and Nicobar (निकोबार) were symbolically renamed **Shaheed** and **Swaraj** (स्वराज).
- Famous appeal: **"Give me blood and I will give you freedom." Jai Hind** was the INA salute that entered national usage.
- The **Rani Jhansi Regiment**, the women's wing, was led by **Lakshmi Swaminathan (Sehgal)**.
- The INA fought alongside Japan in the **Imphal–Kohima campaigns of 1944**.

Result

- The INA collapsed once Japan was defeated, and its officers were later tried at the Red Fort (14.10).
- Bose died on **18 August 1945** in the Taihoku air-crash account, but the INA's stand and the trials that followed did lasting damage to British confidence in the loyalty of Indian troops.

> **Logic:** Azad Hind Government = **21 Oct 1943 Singapore**. Rani Jhansi = INA women, **not** 1857.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q45):** Female Regiment of Azad Hind Fauj: **Rani Jhansi Regiment** (formed 1943 under Subhas Chandra Bose, led by Lakshmi Swaminathan/Sahgal; other INA brigades: Subhash, Gandhi, Nehru, Azad).

14.10 INA Trials

Where: Red Fort, Delhi When: November 1945 onwards **First trio: Prem Kumar Sahgal, Shah Nawaz Khan, Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon** (Hindu–Muslim–Sikh)

Cause

- Captured INA officers were put on trial for waging war against the King. The British meant the trials as a warning; Indian opinion read them as trials of patriots.

Course

- The first famous trio — **Sahgal, Shah Nawaz Khan and Dhillon** — was tried at the **Red Fort**. Defence Committee led by **Bhulabhai Desai**, with **Tej (उष्णकटिबंधीय पूर्वी जेट) Bahadur Sapru**, **K.N. Katju**, **Asaf Ali** and **Nehru**. **Patel** is the classic "not on the defence team" trap.
- **Rashid Ali** drew a **seven-year** sentence in related proceedings; the famous trio faced transportation for life before remission.
- **Azad Hind Fauj Week 5–11 November 1945**; **Azad Hind Fauj Day 12 November 1945**. Mass protest filled the streets.

Result

- Commander-in-Chief **Claude Auchinleck** remitted the heavy sentences under mass pressure.
- **Mohan Singh** is **not** among the Red Fort trio defendants. Do not place the trials at Gwalior, Amer or Agra.
- The trials turned military defeat into a political storm and deepened British doubt about the loyalty of Indian troops — pressure that fed the **1945–47** endgame.

> **Logic:** INA trials = **Red Fort**. Trio = Sahgal, Shah Nawaz, Dhillon.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q21)**: The historic INA court-martial trials were held at the **Red Fort, Delhi** (Nov 1945) against Col. Prem Sehgal, Col. Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon, and Maj. Gen. Shah Nawaz Khan.

14.11 Political Deadlock (formulas)

C.R. Formula (1944)

- The author is **C. Rajagopalachari**, not **C.R. Das**.
- Congress would accept a post-war commission on Pakistan if the League backed independence and a period of central defence and foreign affairs.
- Gandhi–Jinnah talks on this formula failed.
- The **C.R. Formula (1944)** was prepared by **C. Rajagopalachari**, not C.R. Das.

Desai–Liaquat Pact (January 1945)

Actors: Bhulabhai Desai (Congress Central Assembly leader) and **Liaquat Ali Khan** (Muslim League deputy leader)

Cause

- After Cripps and wartime deadlock, informal Congress–League contacts sought an interim coalition formula before a full constitutional settlement.

Course

- Desai and Liaquat sketched an interim government with **parity of representation** for Congress and the League in the Central Executive (minority seats also reserved in the usual telling).
- The talks were **informal**; neither Gandhi nor Jinnah gave a firm public endorsement that stuck.

Result

- The pact itself did not hold, but it kept the idea of a parity-based interim executive alive and fed into the climate of the **Wavell Plan / Simla Conference (June–July 1945)**.

> **Logic:** C.R. = **Rajaji** (राजाजी). Das died **1925** and cannot author a 1944 formula. Desai–Liaquat = **1945** interim parity talk, not the Wavell Plan itself.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q96)**: C. Rajagopalachari prepared the **"C.R. Formula"** (March 1944) to resolve the political deadlock between the Indian National Congress and the Muslim League on the basis of a plebiscite in contiguous Muslim-majority areas.

14.12 Wavell Plan and Simla Conference

Viceroy: Lord **Wavell Plan announced: June 1945 Simla Conference: June–July 1945**

Cause

- With the war in Europe over and Japan's defeat approaching, Wavell wanted to restart political talks and give India a genuinely Indian executive before deciding its post-war constitutional future.

Course

- The **Wavell Plan (June 1945)** proposed reconstructing the **Viceroy's Executive Council** as all-Indian except the Viceroy and Commander-in-Chief, with **caste-Hindu and Muslim** seats equal, League and Congress each nominating their members.
- The **Simla Conference (June–July 1945)** was called to work out the nominations.
- It failed when **Jinnah** demanded that the League alone nominate **all Muslim members**, with no Congress Muslim included; Congress refused to accept a veto on its own Muslim members.

Result

- The talks broke down without forming the new Council, leaving the deadlock over Muslim representation unresolved going into 1946.
- Place Wavell/Simla **after Cripps 1942** and **before Cabinet Mission 1946** (after Cripps **1942**, before Cabinet Mission **1946**).

> **Logic:** Wavell Plan and Simla are **1945**, not 1946. 1946 = Cabinet Mission.

14.13 Cabinet Mission (1946)

Members: Pethick-Lawrence, Stafford Cripps, A.V. Alexander (सिकंदर) In India: March 1946 **Plan: 16 May 1946**

Cause

- The Simla failure of 1945 had left the Congress–League deadlock unresolved. Attlee's new Labour government wanted a fresh, detailed constitutional plan before committing to any transfer of power.

Course

- Three British Cabinet ministers — **Pethick-Lawrence** (chair), **Stafford Cripps**, **A.V. Alexander** — arrived in India in **March 1946** and issued their plan on **16 May 1946**. **Wavell** was Viceroy, not a Cabinet Mission member.
- The plan sketched a **three-tier** polity (Union / groups / provinces) and rejected a sovereign Pakistan as the starting point.
- **Gandhi** (गांधी) called it the best document Britain could produce in the circumstances. Congress President during Mission talks = **Maulana Azad** (also the Cripps/Wavell negotiator tag).
- It did **not** concede a sovereign Pakistan as a first principle. It proposed instead a **weak Centre** for defence, foreign affairs and communications, with provinces placed in **three groups**: **Group A** (Madras, Bombay, UP, Bihar, CP, Orissa), **Group B** (Punjab, NWFP, Sindh) and **Group C** (Bengal, Assam). There would be a Constituent Assembly and an interim government, and provinces could later reconsider their grouping.
- The League first **accepted** the plan, then **withdrew on 29 July 1946** after Nehru's remarks appeared to deny the binding nature of the grouping scheme.

Result

- The League's withdrawal led it to call **Direct Action Day** for **16 August 1946** (full card in 14.15), but it still **joined the Interim Government on 26 October 1946**.
- Both facts can be true: the League withdrew from the Cabinet Mission Plan in **July 1946**, yet still joined the Interim Government in **October 1946**. Joining the Interim does **not** explain the earlier withdrawal.

> **Logic:** Cabinet Mission **1946**. Withdrawal ≠ never joining Interim. Both facts true; not cause-and-effect as R claims.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2018):** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not correct explanation of (A) — Muslim League withdrew acceptance of Cabinet Mission Plan over Congress statements on Constituent Assembly majority; later joined Interim Government on 13 Oct 1946 upon Wavell's repeated requests.

14.14 RIN Mutiny (18–23 February 1946)

Where: Bombay, spreading to Karachi, Calcutta, Vizag and other naval stations **Ship where it began:** *HMIS Talwar* **Rating leaders: M.S. Khan**, Madan Singh

Cause

- Royal Indian Navy ratings mutinied over **racial discrimination, poor food and pay, and slow demobilisation** after the war, and in solidarity with the INA prisoners then on trial.

Course

- Ratings on *HMIS Talwar* refused duty on **18 February 1946**; the mutiny spread within days to some **seventy-odd ships (नावाध्यक्ष) and shore establishments** across Bombay, Karachi, Calcutta and Vizag.
- Bombay's working class and students joined sympathy strikes and street protests; there was firing and loss of life before the Navy restored order by **23 February**.
- This was a **ratings' mutiny**, not a Congress-organised satyagraha, though Congress and the League both mediated to end it.

Result

- The mutiny showed the British that the **loyalty of the armed forces could no longer be assumed** — the same anxiety the INA trials had already exposed a few months earlier.
- It added to the pressure that led directly into the **Cabinet Mission's announcement** later that same February. Place RIN strictly in **February 1946**, after the UK Parliamentary Delegation and just before that announcement.

> **Logic:** RIN Mutiny = **February 1946**, Bombay, *HMIS Talwar*. Not the same event as Quit India **1942**.

14.15 Direct Action Day and the Road to Partition

Called by: Muhammad Ali Jinnah and the **Muslim League Council Date: 16 August 1946**

Cause

- The League called Direct Action Day after the Cabinet Mission talks collapsed and after Congress alone entered Interim Government negotiations on terms the League rejected. The League wanted a show of strength for Pakistan outside the British constitutional timetable.

Course

- The call was for a **province-wide general strike and mass demonstration** in support of Pakistan; it was not framed as a formal satyagraha.
- In **Calcutta**, the day set off severe **communal killing** that ran for several days; violence then spread to **Noakhali** (East Bengal) and, in reprisal, to **Bihar**.
- The **Great Calcutta Killings of August 1946** are treated as the opening act of the communal violence that continued into 1947.

- Renewed rioting followed in **Punjab and the NWFP** through late 1946 and 1947 as the transfer-of-power talks dragged on.

Result

- **Partition** emerged from this spiral as the price both the League and, eventually, Congress accepted to stop the killing and reach a fixed transfer date — it was not a British-imposed idea from the start, but a solution both major parties came to accept by 1947.
- The final territorial line came only with the **Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947)** and the **Radcliffe Boundary Commission**; the human cost was **large-scale refugee movement and communal killing** on both sides of the new Punjab and Bengal borders.
- Keep the sequence clear: **Direct Action Day (16 Aug 1946)** is the spark; **communal violence 1946–47** is the climate; the **Mountbatten Plan and Boundary Commission (1947)** is the actual partition mechanism.

> **Logic:** Direct Action Day **16 August 1946** precedes and drives the pressure toward the **June 1947** partition decision. It is a League call, not a Congress movement.

14.16 Final Phase (1945–47)

- The **UK Parliamentary Delegation** came in **January 1946** and sat at Delhi.
- The **RIN Revolt** of **February 1946** (full card above) hit just before the Cabinet Mission's announcement.
- Attlee **announced the Cabinet Mission on 19 February 1946**. The Mission arrived on **24 March**.
- The **Interim Government** was announced on **24 August 1946** and took office on **2 September 1946**, headed by **Nehru** (Vice-President of the Executive Council / External Affairs).
- Stock portfolios: **Rajendra Prasad** Food & Agriculture; **Patel** Home / princely; **Asaf Ali** Railways & Transport; **Jagjivan Ram** Labour; **Baldev Singh** Defence. **Ambedkar** (अम्बेडकर) and **Azad** were **not** in the first Interim Cabinet.
- League joined on **26 October**; **Liaquat Ali Khan** took **Finance** (controversial budget). Direct Action Day (**16 August**) had already flared at Calcutta–Noakhali.
- **Direct Action Day (16 August 1946)** and the communal violence that followed (full card above) hardened the drive toward Partition.
- **Attlee's statement of 20 February 1947** promised transfer of power by **June 1948**.
- Order: Cabinet Delegation arrival (**March 1946**), then RIN Revolt (**February 1946** is earlier — watch chronology traps), then Cabinet Mission plan (**16 May 1946**), then Interim Government (**September 1946**).

> **Logic:** Announcement of Cabinet Mission in **February 1946** is not the same as formation of the Interim in **September 1946**.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q16):** Chronology ladder: UK Parliamentary Delegation arrival in Delhi (Jan 1946) → Royal Indian Navy Revolt (18–23 Feb 1946) → Announcement of Cabinet Mission (19 Feb 1946) → Formation of Interim Government (Sept 1946).

14.17 Attlee's Statement (20 February 1947)

Who: British Prime Minister **Clement Attlee**, in the House of Commons

- Attlee announced that His Majesty's Government intended to transfer power to Indian hands by **a date not later than June 1948**.
- He stated that if Indian parties could not agree on a constitution through the existing Constituent Assembly machinery, the British government would have to decide **to whom** power should be transferred — a clear signal that a united transfer was no longer guaranteed if Congress and the League stayed deadlocked.
- The statement announced that **Lord Mountbatten would replace Wavell as Viceroy** to carry the transfer through.
- This is the announcement that fixed a **deadline** for the first time. Everything before it (Cripps, Wavell Plan, Cabinet Mission) had offered a scheme without a hard date.
- Mountbatten arrived in **March 1947** and, finding the June 1948 timetable unworkable given the communal violence, advanced the date to **15 August 1947** in his own Plan of 3 June.
- Do not confuse Attlee's **February 1947** announcement (a deadline statement) with **Mountbatten's June 1947** Plan (the actual partition mechanism) or the **Indian Independence Act's July 1947** royal assent (the legal instrument).

> **Logic:** Attlee **20 Feb 1947** = June 1948 deadline + names Mountbatten. Mountbatten himself **advanced** that date to 15 August 1947.

14.18 Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947)

Viceroy: Lord **Mountbatten** (arrived March 1947) **Plan: 3 June 1947** (also called June 3 Plan)

Cause

- Attlee's February 1947 deadline of June 1948 had not stopped worsening communal violence after Direct Action Day. Mountbatten, arriving in March 1947, judged that a firmer, faster date was the only way to prevent a fuller breakdown.

Course

- Mountbatten's staff first drafted a fragmented **Plan Balkan / Dickie Bird Plan (May 1947)** under **General Hastings (हेस्टिंग्स) Ismay**: power would devolve to provinces and princely states with freedom to join India, Pakistan, or remain separate. When Mountbatten showed the draft secretly to **Nehru** at Simla, Nehru rejected it as a recipe for chaos; Mountbatten scrapped it.

- He then settled the **3 June 1947** Plan: two dominions; Punjab/Bengal partition votes; NWFP/Sylhet referendums; states to choose accession.
- A Boundary Commission under **Cyril Radcliffe** drew the line. **V.P. Menon** drafted much of the plan. Congress AICC accepted partition at Delhi (**14–15 June 1947**) under President **J.B. Kripalani**; resolution moved by **G.B. Pant**, seconded by **Azad**. **Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan** voted against; **Saifuddin Kitchlew** called it surrender of nationalism to communalism.
- Gandhi had urged Mountbatten to invite **Jinnah** to form the government as an alternative to partition — Congress leadership did not accept that line. At midnight **14/15 August**, **Sucheta Kripalani** sang *Jana Gana Mana (माना)* and *Sare Jahan Se Achha* in the Assembly.

Result

- Transfer of power was advanced from the promised June 1948 to **15 August 1947**, compressing the practical work of partition into just over two months.
- The plan became law through the **Indian Independence Act (18 July 1947)**, taught next.
- **Plan Balkan** is the discarded May draft; the **Mountbatten Plan** is the accepted **3 June** framework — do not swap them.

> **Logic:** Mountbatten Plan = **3 June 1947**. The **Act** is **18 July**. Independence Day = **15 August**. Plan Balkan ≠ June 3 Plan.

14.19 Indian Independence Act, 1947

Passed: 18 July 1947 (Royal Assent) **Effect: 15 August 1947**

- It created two independent **dominions**, India and Pakistan.
- It ended British paramountcy over the princely states.
- Each dominion had a Governor-General (गवर्नर-जनरल), with the Constituent Assembly as legislature.
- The **GOI Act 1935** continued as a temporary frame until a new constitution.
- **15 August** is independence. **18 July** is the statute. Do not swap.
- Partition violence and refugee movement are the human cost. Princely integration belongs to the next chapter.

> **Logic:** Act **18 July 1947** ≠ 3 June Plan (3 जून योजना) ≠ 15 August.

UP Focus

Fact	Detail
Ballia parallel government	**Chittu Pandey**, Quit India, UP
Ramgarh 1940	Congress session (Azad) — 2024 Q133

Fact	Detail
UP Congress ministry, 1937	Formed after the provincial elections; **G.B. Pant** as Premier
Bihar violence after Direct Action	Reprisal killings spread from Noakhali/Calcutta into **Bihar**, 1946